

This roadmap
online

M.A. in Music roadmap

Four semesters of full-time study, 8 units a semester · Graduate Coordinator: Inés Thiebaut,
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Degree	Entry	Emphases	Catalog
Master of Arts in Music	Fall A (even years)	Performance (Classical or Jazz), Choral Conducting, Composition	2027–2028

01 Degree at a glance

Component	Units
Graduate seminars (eight courses)	16
Graduate Applied Study (MUS 661–668)	8
Ensemble (MUS 351–355, 360–369, four semesters)	4
Capstone (MUS 693, four semesters)	4
Total	32

Note

FAST B.A./M.A. students follow the FAST roadmaps. The Certificate in Music Education can be added to the M.A.

02 Milestones

Advancement to candidacy is at the end of the first year, after 2 units from MUS 601 or MUS 602, 2 units from MUS 604, MUS 605, or MUS 631, 4 units of Graduate Applied Study, and 2 units of ensemble, with a grade point average of at least 3.0. It must be on record before the final semester.

The capstone (a public recital, conducting performance, or lecture on a composition portfolio, by emphasis) and the comprehensive examination are in the final semester. The examination is a degree requirement that has no units.

2026–2027 cohort

In the 2026–2027 catalog, MUS 603 is 3 units, and MUS 693 is 3 units over three semesters.

03 Semester by semester

First semester (fall A)

Course	Title	Units
MUS 601	Analysis of Musical Styles: Birth and Death of Tonality	2
MUS 603	Entrepreneurship in the Arts	2
MUS 661–668	Graduate Applied Study	2
MUS 351–355, 360–369	Ensemble	1
MUS 693	Capstone, 1 of 4	1
Semester total		8

Third semester (fall B)

Course	Title	Units
MUS 602	Analysis of Musical Styles: Post-Tonality and Beyond	2
MUS 630	Advanced Conducting	2
MUS 661–668	Graduate Applied Study	2
MUS 351–355, 360–369	Ensemble	1
MUS 693	Capstone, 3 of 4	1
Semester total		8

Second semester (spring A)

Course	Title	Units
MUS 605	History and Theory of Jazz	2
MUS 606	Interdisciplinary Collaboration in Music	2
MUS 661–668	Graduate Applied Study	2
MUS 351–355, 360–369	Ensemble	1
MUS 693	Capstone, 2 of 4	1
Semester total		8

Fourth semester (spring B)

Course	Title	Units
MUS 631	Teaching Music in Higher Education	2
MUS 604	Sounding Justice: Unveiling the Ecological and Social Dimensions of Music	2
MUS 661–668	Graduate Applied Study	2
MUS 351–355, 360–369	Ensemble	1
MUS 693	Capstone, 4 of 4	1
Semester total		8